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MARIGOLD

Digital cash in fixed notes.

Notes you hold, hand over, and understand.

LITEPAPER · SECOND EDITION · OCTOBER 2026

Nº 000001 — specimen

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THE PROBLEM

Digital Money Forgot What Cash Got Right

Take a dollar bill out of your wallet. Notice three things:

1

Whoever holds it owns it.

There is no account, no login, no intermediary. Possession is ownership.

2

It carries no memory.

The bill does not remember who spent it last. There is no record tying you to the coffee you bought this morning.

3

Anyone can check it is real.

Hold it to the light, feel the paper. No special expertise required.

No mainstream digital money reproduces all three of these properties at once.

Bitcoin gives you the first and third: holding your keys means owning your coins, and anyone can verify the system is honest. But it fails badly on the second. Every Bitcoin ever mined carries its full history permanently and publicly. Every address you have ever sent from or received to is stitched together in a graph that anyone can analyze. Your coins remember everything you ever did with them. There is a quieter gap as well: Bitcoin can be stored offline as a QR code, but it cannot be used to pay the way an offline banknote can — spending it means broadcasting a transaction. Marigold is specifically designed so that a note can be handed over like cash.

Privacy coins like Monero and Zcash try to fix this by encrypting the history. They succeed at hiding things — but the very cryptography that does the hiding creates two new problems. First, almost nobody can personally verify that the system is honest. You are trusting experts you have never met that the math contains no flaw, no backdoor. Second, regulators take one look at the complex cryptography and classify the coin accordingly — delistings, restrictions, and adversarial treatment follow not from what the coin does but from how it does it.

The result is a landscape where you choose between transparency without privacy, or privacy without trust. Physical cash offered both, effortlessly. Digital money somehow forgot how.

THE INSIGHT

Don't Hide the Trail — Don't Make One

Imagine you are at a market stall. You hand a five-dollar bill to the vendor. The vendor puts it in the register. Later that day, the vendor spends that same bill at the bakery. The bakery gives it as change to the next customer.

Now ask: who can trace that bill back to you? Nobody. Not because the bill's journey was encrypted or hidden — the bill was in plain view every step of the way — but because the bill itself never recorded who handed it to whom. The connection between you and the vendor was never written down. It existed only in the moment of handover and then was gone.

This is the difference between hiding information and never collecting it.

> Privacy coins hide. Marigold doesn't collect.

HOW IT WORKS

Notes Instead of Accounts

Most cryptocurrencies work like bank accounts. You have an address (like an account number), and transactions move value between addresses. The addresses are public, and every movement between them is recorded forever. It is an accountant's dream and a privacy nightmare.

Marigold works like cash. There are no accounts. Instead, the system maintains a pool of **notes** — think of them as digital banknotes.

Each note is a simple public record:

- A **serial number** (like the serial number on a dollar bill)
- A **value** (0.01, 0.1, 1, 10, 100, 1,000, 10,000, or 100,000 MAGLD)
- A **lock** (a public key — whoever holds the matching key can spend it)

That's it. No owner name, no address, no identity. The note does not know who holds it. It knows only that a key exists, and that whoever can unlock it can spend it.

MAKING A PAYMENT

Paying someone is like handing over a bill, with one extra step:

1. **You give the recipient the key** to the note (via QR code, text message, or even verbally — the same way you'd share a photo).
2. **The recipient immediately swaps the lock** — they record a transaction that replaces your key with a brand-new key that only they know. This is confirmed in under a second.

Once that swap is confirmed, the note is irrevocably theirs. You no longer hold a key that works. Settlement is done.

Alternatively, if the recipient can send you their new key ahead of time (say, via a payment request), you can swap the lock directly to their key. Your key never travels anywhere.

The third way is for paying someone who is not there. You swap the lock to a key only they hold and put a deadline on it. Until the deadline, only they can take the note; from the deadline on, only you can take it back. They collect when they like; if they never do, the money is yours again by itself. The deadline is enforced by the network, not by anyone's wallet.

All three end the same way: the note sits under a key that only the recipient knows.

SPLITTING AND MERGING

Notes come in fixed values, just like physical currency. If you need to pay 30 MAGLD and you hold a 100-MAGLD note, you **split** it into ten 10-MAGLD notes. You hand over three of them. You keep seven. Making change — same as cash.

Going the other way, ten 10-MAGLD notes can be **merged** into one 100-MAGLD note. The values move in factors of ten, so any amount is payable with a small handful of notes.

WHAT THE SYSTEM RECORDS

Every operation — creating, swapping locks, splitting, merging, redeeming — is public and in plain view. What no one can see is **who** did it, because the system has no concept of "who." There is no sender field. No receiver field. No address book. No account.

> The system records that a note changed hands.
> It does not record whose hands.

A note under a deadline also shows its terms — the deadline, and the key it goes back to — for as long as the deadline stands.

IN PRACTICE

Using Marigold in the Real World

Because a Marigold note is nothing more than a key, using one in the real world is as simple as using physical cash. Here is how:

PRINT IT, SPEND IT

Every note in your wallet app can be displayed as a **QR code**. You can print that QR code on a piece of paper, fold it up, and put it in your leather wallet — right next to your credit cards and your driver's license. That piece of paper *is* the money. Show it to someone, and they scan it, swap the lock, and the note is theirs. You no longer hold a working key. The paper in your pocket is now worthless — the value has moved to them.

This is not a metaphor. The printed QR code holds the actual key. Losing it is like losing a hundred-dollar bill: whoever finds it can spend it. Keeping it safe is the same responsibility as keeping cash safe. There is no recovery hotline, no "report this stolen" button, no bank to reverse the transaction. That is what bearer means, and it is the entire point.

GIFT IT

A birthday card with a printed QR code inside is indistinguishable from a birthday card with a fifty-dollar bill inside. The recipient scans it, swaps the lock immediately, and the note is irrevocably theirs. No account to set up, no waiting period. They open the envelope, they hold the money.

LEAVE AN INHERITANCE

A sealed envelope in a safe deposit box, containing printed QR codes for several notes, functions exactly like an envelope of cash. Whoever opens it holds the keys. Whoever holds the keys holds the notes. No executor, no probate court, no third-party permission is needed for the value to transfer — though, as with physical cash, the *legal* arrangements around inheritance are a separate matter the system does not and cannot address. The system guarantees only that possession of the key is possession of the note.

PAY AT A MARKET STALL

You are buying tomatoes. The vendor displays a QR code — their payment request. You scan it with your wallet app, select the note you want to pay with, and your phone swaps the lock directly to the vendor's key. Under one second later, the note is theirs. You pocket your tomatoes. The vendor never saw your name, your address, or your account. You never saw theirs. The transaction is settled, final, and forgettable — just like cash.

BE PAID WHILE YOU ARE AWAY

Publish one key — on your business card, in your shop window, in your profile — and anyone can pay you at any hour. Each payment lands under a fresh key that only your wallet can work out from the one you published, so the chain never shows two payments arriving at the same place. A payment to it can carry a deadline, so the sender knows the money comes back to them if you never collect. Your wallet collects whatever is waiting the next time it is running.

STORE IT COLD

Worried about hackers? Print your notes as QR codes, put them in a fireproof box, and delete the app. The notes exist on the blockchain. The keys exist on paper. No internet-connected device holds them. When you want to spend, scan the QR code back into a wallet app, swap the lock immediately (in case someone copied the paper while it was stored), and transact normally.

MOVE BETWEEN WALLETS

Because notes are independent keys and not tied to any seed phrase or account, you can move a note from one wallet app to another at any time. Export the key from one app, import it into another. No on-chain transaction required, no fee paid, no interaction with the network at all. Your note works the same way in every wallet that supports Marigold — pick the app you like, switch whenever you want, your money comes with you.

The common thread: a Marigold note is a key, and a key can be printed, texted, folded into an envelope, stuck on a refrigerator, or committed to memory. The system does not care how the key travels between people, because the system does not know that people exist. It knows only keys and notes — and that is why every way you can move a physical banknote has a direct digital equivalent here.

And none of it needs a connection. Bitcoin can be kept offline as a QR code, but it cannot be spent that way: paying with it means broadcasting a transaction, so somebody has to be online, and a wallet that is never online cannot pay. A Marigold note is the key itself, so the note can pass from hand to hand offline, exactly like a banknote; the network is touched only when the new holder decides to swap the lock. You do not need to be connected to pay, and you do not need a wallet that is permanently online.

ON YOUR PHONE

Your Phone Is a Remote Control, Not a Wallet

Everything you can do at your own keyboard, you can do from your phone, in a Telegram chat: check your balance, pay someone, take in a note, raise a payment request, read your history, see whether your miner is running. What changes is not what you can do. It is where the money is — and the money is not on the phone.

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> It is where the money is — and the money is not on the phone.

Your wallet runs at home, on whatever stays switched on: a laptop in a drawer, a small computer beside the router. It keeps itself in step with the chain, it holds your notes, and it answers your messages. The phone in your pocket holds no keys and stores no notes. It talks to nothing but Telegram. Lose it, and you have lost a remote control.

The bot is yours, not ours. You make it in Telegram in about two minutes, hand your wallet the token, and pair the two with a code. From then on your wallet answers that one Telegram account and ignores every other. There is no Marigold server in the middle, no account with us, no fleet of machines we run for your

phone to depend on. Your wallet calls out to Telegram; nothing calls in, and there is nothing to open on your router.

Spending is guarded the way a bank card is: a PIN before anything that moves money, a lockout after three wrong tries that only the machine at home can clear, and a daily limit you set yourself. That Telegram account can now move money, so it needs two-factor authentication — the bot tells you so the first time you speak to it.

The same chat keeps your backup. Once you ask it to, the wallet posts an encrypted copy of every wallet on your computer there — the one you use and the one you put aside — and keeps it current by itself — a full copy every day, the changes within minutes of a payment, only the last two copies kept — quietly, with no notification. If the machine at home dies, you forward those messages back to a fresh wallet and it is all there. Each wallet's copy is locked with that wallet's 24 words and with nothing else: not your wallet password, which you type every day and chose to be able to remember, and which anyone holding a copy of the file could try at leisure. The 24 words cannot be guessed. Write them down when the wallet shows them — it will ask you for two of them to make sure — and a backup on someone else's server is just noise to everyone but you.

The limits, plainly. When the machine at home is off, the phone can do nothing at all: no balance, no paying, no receiving. A payment code sent through a chat is bearer value while it is in flight, exactly like the printed QR codes above — whoever reads it first can claim it. And a proper phone app, one that holds keys itself, is a job for later and probably for someone else. This is the version that asks you to trust nobody.

There is a second way to use the phone, with no bot at all and entirely offline: as a place to keep notes as pictures. A note is a key, and a QR code of that key is the money itself, so a phone holding a few such pictures is a wallet with a few banknotes in it — and handing one over needs no signal, no account and no app, only a screen the other person can scan. Treat them exactly like cash: anyone who sees, copies or scans one can claim the note by putting their own lock on it, so a screenshot in a shared album is a banknote left on a table. Marigold has no standalone phone app on purpose. The full wallet runs on a computer you control, and the phone is either its remote control or a pocket for notes.

HONESTY

What an Observer Can and Cannot See

Marigold is not a privacy coin, and this litepaper will not pretend it is. Here is exactly what someone watching the system can figure out:

- **They can see:** Every note, every value, every operation, the total supply, and the complete current state of the system. All of it is in plain view. Nothing is encrypted, ever.
- **They can see:** The chain of operations — which note was swapped into which new note, when splits and merges happened, timing patterns. A determined analyst studying the public records can identify behavioral patterns: rapid successive payments, split-then-spend sequences, or a merchant's daily accept-and-merge rhythm.
- **They can see:** Who created and redeemed notes, if they can link a regular blockchain address to a real-world identity. The points where Marigold connects to the traditional blockchain world are fully

visible.

- **They cannot see:** Any identity attached to a payment within the system. There is nothing to see, because the data was never recorded.

A note blends in with every other note of the same value — a 100-MAGLD note looks like every other 100-MAGLD note and nothing beyond that group. Wallet software can blur behavioral patterns (slightly randomizing timing, grouping operations together, varying which note sizes are used for fees), but this is good habits, not magic. Marigold makes no stronger claim.

ACCOUNTABILITY

Why It Is Honest Money

Every few seconds, every participant verifies a single rule:

```
All notes in existence + all coins on the traditional side
= total coins ever mined
```

VERIFIED BY EVERY NODE · EVERY BLOCK

If this does not hold, something is wrong and the network can see it immediately. Supply is accountable at every moment — not by trusting an auditor, not by trusting a complex proof system, but by the kind of arithmetic anyone can do.

No value is ever created or destroyed within the system. Paying a fee removes a note from the pool, but its value is credited to the miner and can be recreated as a new note at any time. The conservation rule is absolute and universal.

SPEED

The Chain: Fast Enough to Feel Like Cash

The settlement rule is simple: a note is yours when your lock swap is confirmed on the network. That means **confirmation time is handover time.** On Bitcoin, you would stand at the market stall for ten minutes. On Ethereum, about twelve seconds. On Marigold, under one second.

BITCOIN	ETHEREUM	MARIGOLD
10 min	~12 s	< 1 s

Marigold runs on a proof-of-work blockchain that produces approximately 10 blocks per second, giving sub-second confirmation. The underlying technology was built by the Kaspa project — a fast, reliable, well-tested blockchain. Marigold adds the note system and its economics on top of that foundation, leaving the base layer intact because it does its job exceptionally well.

A note on energy. Marigold's energy story is not that it uses little — a proof-of-work chain attracts as much mining as its rewards are worth, and a successful Marigold will be no exception. The story is that none of it buys waiting. A classical blockchain can accept only one block per round; blocks mined in parallel are thrown away, so the network stays secure only by staying slow. The chain Marigold runs on keeps every block — blocks found at the same moment are woven into the ledger together, all of them counting — which is how the same security budget delivers ten blocks per second and sub-second settlement instead of a ten-minute queue. Per payment, that is an enormous efficiency difference. In total, it is the same honest arithmetic as everything else here: energy spent in proportion to the value being protected.

ECONOMICS

Economics at a Glance

SUPPLY	210,000,000 MAGLD, hard cap. No premine, no dev fund, no allocation of any kind.
LAUNCH	Fair launch from day one. Software available to everyone in advance. Everyone starts on equal footing.
EMISSION	Smooth and gradual — the mining reward halves every three years without sudden drops. About 21% is mined in year one, ~90% by year ten.
BASE UNIT	1 MAGLD = 100,000,000 petals.
SMALLEST NOTE	0.01 MAGLD, and the fee is one such note. Should 1 MAGLD come to be worth more than about a dollar, a 0.001 note (or smaller) is added by a network upgrade and the fee becomes that new smallest note; every existing note stays as it is.
COST TO PAY	0.01 MAGLD — one hundredth of a coin — for any everyday payment, however much you are sending. The fee is a single small note handed over with the payment, so a coffee and a car cost the same to move. Only unusually large operations, bundling dozens of notes at once, step up to two or three hundredths.
FEES	All fees go to miners. Nothing is burned, nothing is diverted. A cash economy — where every payment is an on-chain transaction — produces steady fee income that store-of-value chains cannot match.

THE ANCHORS

A Small Safeguard That Stays

A new proof-of-work chain has little mining power, and little mining power invites attacks. Marigold has a fully disclosed safeguard called **finality anchors**: five publicly identified trustees periodically co-sign (at least 3 of 5) a recent block, making it permanent. No one can undo an anchored block, however much mining power they bring.

The trustees cannot censor transactions, create coins, move anyone's funds, or produce blocks. Their only power is to prevent undoing completed transactions. If they go silent, the chain carries on as an ordinary proof-of-work network — somewhat less protected, but fully working.

Earlier versions of this paper called the anchors training wheels, to come off once the network was strong. They stay, and the reason is your wallet. Most wallets do not run a node of their own: your wallet asks a public computer for the latest anchor, checks the trustees' signatures on it, checks the notes it is handed against that anchored block, finds your own notes among them without telling anyone which they are, and follows along from there. The anchor is the one thing your wallet can hold a public computer to. Without it, a wallet without a node would have to take that computer's word for everything.

So the honest statement is this: the five trustees are trusted not to sign a false anchor, for as long as Marigold runs. Three of them together could; with a cooperating public computer, they could mislead a wallet that runs no node. Anyone who wants no trustee in the loop can run a node of their own, which checks every block itself. The founders choose the first five trustees, not the last: replacing them is meant to pass to the people who hold notes, and how a trustee hands over to a successor is being designed now.

On the public testnet the safeguard is running: five trustee keys, an anchor roughly every thirty seconds, every node enforcing, every wallet starting from the latest anchor. The testnet trustees are throwaway keys made for the rehearsal; the real set is chosen at launch.



Marigold is digital cash. Notes are bearer instruments. Possession of the key is ownership. Transfer of the key is settlement. The chain is complete about value and silent about people — exactly like a dollar bill.

Marigold is not a privacy coin. Nothing is encrypted. Nothing is hidden. The distinction is not euphemism: privacy coins cryptographically conceal recorded data, and Marigold records no data to conceal. What it shares with cash is specific and honestly bounded — the system is complete about *value* by design, and silent about *people* by design.

Marigold is five operations, one conservation rule, plain-view state, ordinary digital signatures, a fixed supply checked by everyone at every moment, on a network fast enough that handing over a note feels like handing over a bill.

Everything it does can be checked by the people it is for.

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No token sale. No presale. Nothing to buy yet.